

Marathon Training Interview — Text Transcript

Reconstructed from screenshots of a text message conversation

Interviewer: After homework

Interviewee: what class?

Interviewee: and ya!

Interviewer: New product dev

Interviewee: kk ya can answer over text

Interviewee: or can call you around 8

Interviewer: Oh yeah let's just do over text pls

Interviewee: kk hit me

Interviewer: 1. How many marathons have you run?
2. Walk me through how you found a training plan
3. Describe how the training cycle went

Interviewee: 1. 8 marathons

Interviewer: Holy shit what I didn't know that

Interviewee: lol yeah i think 8 - 5 nyc, 1 philly, 1 boston, 1 london

Interviewee: actually maybe its 4 nyc

Interviewer: How do you usually find a training plan?

Interviewee: 2. For my first marathon, was just training to finish. Probably was running too much tbh and doing close to no strength training. For my 3rd new york, I worked with a coach who I met through working at near [sic] and she does private coaching in addition to team coaching w road runners. She set me up with a customized training plan w a huge excel model that i would update each week and then she would adjust accordingly for the following week. For the races after that, I would just repurpose her training plan and follow it (kinda) - i think w each race i became less and less concerned about can i finish bc i had done it so many times before

Interviewee: 2. I also now have a very high level excel model that helps track my mileage to make sure im not increasing too much all at once to help avoid injury

Interviewee: happy to share these two files with you

Interviewer: Oh amazing.

Interviewer: For question three let's just focus on the first two-ish marathons. How did those training cycles go? If you can remember

Interviewee: Ok looks like the coach deleted the og training plan.. but here's the planning sheet i use now. See "2025 planning" for a fully filled sheet

[Shared link: Google Sheets: Sign-in — docs.google.com]

Interviewee: Ok for the first two, i didnt really know what i was doing, but basically just tried to add two to three miles each week to my longest run. I probably couldve been practicing nutrition earlier in the process instead of just during 13+ mile runs

Interviewee: One thing that I have done for each training cycle is an 18 mile race about 6 weeks out from race day. It gets confidence up and reminds you that you can run faster than you've probably been training.

Interviewee: I barely did any speed or hill work - closest thing i got to speed work was tempo runs and would just pick up my speed on every other song that played

Interviewer: This is such type b marathon training I love it

Interviewee: didnt start doing intentional hill workouts until the coach told me to

Interviewer: What about strength training and stretching? How did you integrate those into your programming?

Interviewee: for first two marathons, wouldn't do intentional strength training days but would finish my runs at the gym and stretch out

Interviewee: for second marathon was dealing with some knee pain and going to pt and all that but no strength training that i was particularly doing voluntarily

Interviewee: did lots of yoga for marathons 3+

Interviewer: Interesting. How did the injuries affect the training cycle?

Interviewee: It was mostly runners knee once I would get past 12+ miles. Wouldn't keep me from running but would have me slightly concerned for race day. used kt tape and crossed fingers

Interviewee: for boston, I stopped training entirely about 4 weeks out bc i had a bone spur on my heel that was being agitated by my sneakers lol

Interviewee: but it took the pt a while to figure that one out, and we ended up just cutting a hole in my sneaker to make room for the bone spur

(2 replies in thread — not visible in screenshot)

Interviewee: but I stopped training to "rest" and luckily the longest run i had gotten in was around 17/18 w 4 weeks out but stopping unexpectedly had me so anxious not knowing if the fitness would still be there, especially for a boston-type race

(2 replies in thread — not visible in screenshot)

Interviewer: This is psycho

Interviewer: How did Boston go on race day?

Interviewee: my dad using the exacto knife on race day sneaks

[image/caption, partially cut off in screenshot]

Interviewer: Hahahahaha

Interviewer: Amazing picture

Interviewee: Boston race day felt fine. I had my mom hold an old pair of sneakers w her at mile 20 in case i needed to switch. in reality, the fitness had already be built and the piece that i was weakest on was mostly mental and also it being big scary boston and also not having done much hill training

Interviewee: I think there is something to be said to knowing how to train for the specific course that you are racing

Interviewee: training for boston should look different from training for nyc than training for cim

Interviewee: and for beginners, that is a tricky thing to convince them of

Interviewee: if there's a way to train some of the mental aspects of racing w this app that you are thinking about.. i think that would be a win. bc the mental aspect of it is a huge part, especially if it is your first marathon

Interviewer: That's in the JTBD!

Interviewee: lol what's that

Interviewer: Jobs to be done!

Interviewer: Last question then I'll leave you alone. How does plan flexibility affect your training cycles? If at all

Interviewee: I think having flexible training plans is critical

Interviewee: however it is a balancing act bc you still want to get your mileage in and be safe about it but you also don't want to sacrifice your entire life to marathon training (at least i don't)

Interviewee: So a lot of the time my training might have a long run on a saturday one week and then a wednesday the next week - and as long as you are adjusting everything else to make sure you aren't piling heavy days next to each other, im a firm believer that any day of the week can be a long run

Interviewee: tbh I for years now have liked to bake my long runs into the middle of the week and just wake up early and get it done before work or school - this way there is no escaping it or pushing it off. bc if you pushed it off you would run into your work day, no pun intended

Interviewee: if you look at the excel sheet i sent, you can see that on the rows where i put the actuals, i don't always follow to plan - its just not realistic.

Interviewee: so if you want to live a somewhat normal life, while also training for a marathon, you need to be flexible and be okay with an imperfect training plan

Interviewee: lol sorry im just spitting nonsense rn

Interviewer: Lol no this is perfect

Interviewer: ty ty

Interviewee: trying to give you some quotes